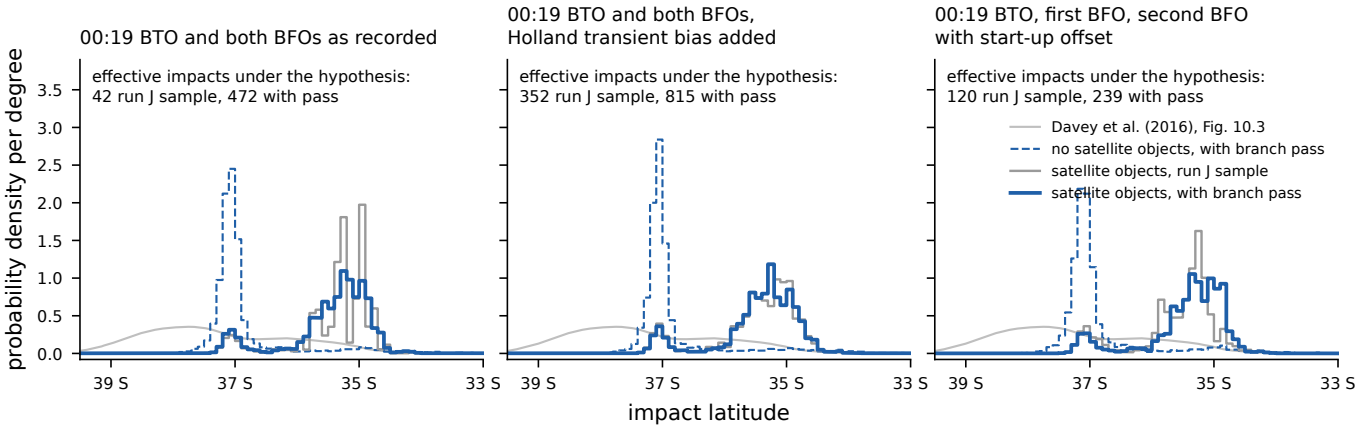
Fuel exhaustion then no control: the satellite-object hypothesis moves the median impact latitude from about 37.1 S to about 35.3 S, where the branch pass still has few samples (both causes, 1/3 other)



Footnote (simple): The data is conditional on the hypothesis that one or more objects seen by satellite on 20-23 March 2014 came from the aircraft. We do not use the shape of the objects. The end of flight physics is provisional. No seabed search is applied. The aircraft cruises to fuel exhaustion, then has no control. 'Run J sample' is the production sample; 'with branch pass' adds 8 seeds that sample only the flame-out, no-control descents. The grey line is the published reference curve for all descents, not only this family.

Footnote (technical): Core run J (split-half accepted as a pass by project ruling, 16 Oct 2026), waypoints stratum (P 0.998), 24 production seeds; D3/D4 production = both-burst set (8 seeds, thinned). A1-branch conditional pass: 8 seeds x 100k hand-offs, branch = onset flame-out-associated and control realised none; stratified estimator Z(d,B) = Z_prod(D0',c,B) E_pass[L_d L_H]/E_pass[L_D0'] (branch replaced). H: Pleiades rating 5 (6 clusters) + COSMO-SkyMed F1-F4, pass-marginal; rho 0.25; GLORYS12+ERA5 and GlobCurrent+ERA5 (product-relative windage), equal prior. A1 latitude histograms, 0.1 deg; Davey et al. (2016) Fig. 10.3 BTO+BFO, recovered from the PDF vector paths. No identity likelihood; no Bayes factor or P(H). Before any seabed search.